

NovaTech Solutions

Travel & Expenses Policy

Guidelines for Business Travel and Reimbursement

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Travel & Expense Reimbursement Policy

This policy governs all business travel and expense claims at NovaTech Solutions. All travel must be pre-approved via the Travel Request module in the HR Portal. Claims must be submitted within **30 days of incurring the expense**; late claims will not be reimbursed without a Director-level exception.

Quick Reference: Daily Allowances

Category	Tier 1 Cities*	Tier 2 Cities	Domestic (GCC)
Meals (per day)	USD 85	USD 65	OMR 25
Hotel (per night)	USD 250	USD 175	OMR 90
Ground transport	Actual + receipt	Actual + receipt	Actual + receipt
Incidentals	USD 20	USD 15	OMR 7

* Tier 1 Cities include: London, New York, Singapore, San Francisco, Zurich, Dubai, Tokyo.

1. Air Travel

All flights must be booked through the approved corporate travel portal (travel.novatech.io) or via the designated travel management company (TMC). Bookings outside this system are not reimbursable without prior Finance approval.

- **Economy class** for all flights under 6 hours.
- **Premium Economy** for flights between 6 and 9 hours (Director level and below).
- **Business Class** for flights over 9 hours, or for employees at VP level and above on any international flight.
- The cheapest available fare must be booked with at least 10 days' advance notice where possible.
- Seat upgrades purchased personally are not reimbursable.
- Frequent flyer miles accrued on company travel belong to the employee.
- Baggage: one checked bag per trip is reimbursable; additional bags require justification.

Note: Emergency same-day bookings or unavoidable last-minute changes must include a brief justification in the expense claim.

2. Hotel Accommodation

Employees should book hotels within the approved nightly rates (see table above). Booking through the corporate portal often yields negotiated rates below these limits.

If a preferred hotel exceeds the limit (e.g., conference hotel), the excess requires a pre-approval from the employee's Head of Department before booking.

- Single occupancy only; the company does not reimburse additional costs for personal guests.
- Hotel loyalty points accrued on company bookings belong to the employee.
- Extended stays (7+ nights) at a single location should consider serviced apartments, which may be more cost-effective.
- Mini-bar, pay-per-view, and in-room spa services are not reimbursable.
- Room service is reimbursable up to the applicable meal allowance.

3. Ground Transport

Employees should use the most cost-effective, safe, and practical mode of ground transportation available.

- Airport taxi or rideshare (Uber/Careem): fully reimbursable with receipt for airport transfers.
- Car rental: permitted for trips requiring more than 2 locations in a day; a Category B (compact) car is the default.
- Personal car mileage: reimbursed at **OMR 0.065 per km** (GCC) or the applicable HMRC mileage rate (UK).
- Train travel (first class permitted for journeys over 2.5 hours).
- Tipping: up to 15% is reimbursable on taxis and restaurant meals.
- Traffic fines and parking violations are the employee's personal responsibility.

4. Meals & Entertainment

Meal expenses up to the daily allowance (see table) are reimbursable without itemisation. Claims exceeding the daily limit require an itemised receipt and a business justification.

Client entertainment (meals, events) must clearly state the business purpose and list all attendees. Client entertainment is subject to a **maximum of USD 150 per person**.

- Alcohol: may be included if culturally appropriate and the client is present; limited to USD 30/person.
- Team lunches/dinners (5+ people) exceeding USD 500 total require VP approval.
- Coffee and light snacks during internal meetings are not individually claimable; use departmental budgets.
- Minibar and room service costs count toward the daily meal allowance.

5. Submitting & Approving Claims

All expense claims must be submitted through the **Expensify integration** within 30 days. Receipts must be attached digitally for any single item over USD 25 / OMR 10.

- Claims are approved by the direct line manager (up to USD 1,000).
- Claims between USD 1,000 and USD 5,000 require Head of Department approval.
- Claims above USD 5,000 require Finance Director sign-off.
- Reimbursements are processed in the monthly payroll run (cut-off: 20th of each month).
- Incorrect or unsupported claims will be returned; employees have 10 days to provide missing documentation.